RYAN MERRILL

Brevard, NC | (828)329-0563 | ryan.merrill@duke.edu | linkedin.com/in/ryanmerrill21

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Third year Mechanical Engineering student at Duke passionate about working with people. Experienced in breaking down problems and systems to identify improvement opportunities, developing data-informed initiatives, driving cross-functional projects end-to-end, and clearly communicating to various types of groups. Excited to explore new opportunities.

EDUCATION

Duke University, *Pratt School of Engineering* Expected: 05/2028
Bachelor-of Science: Mechanical Engineering; Minor: Theater Studies
Innovation & Entrepreneurship Certificate; Concentration: Product Management

EXPERIENCE

Project Engineer Intern, *U.S. Engineering Innovations | Montgomery, AL* 05/2026 - Present

- Conduct root cause analyses of operational data and develop recommendations for leadership, strengthening communication and process effectiveness.
- Collaborate with project managers, superintendents, and field personnel to improve lines of communication, standardize documentation, and support cross-team coordination for successful project completion (*see page 2*).

Admissions Officer Intern, *Duke Undergraduate Admissions | Durham, NC* 08/2026 - Present

- Partner with admissions officers to identify framework to collect and analyze data to evaluate applications to inform recruitment strategy.
- Deliver information sessions to groups of 50 to 100 prospective students and families, in-person and virtually; provide an overview on 1st year academic programs, the application process, and university traditions.
- Support recruitment programming both on campus, hosting visiting high school groups, and off campus at regional high schools, coordinating event setup and serving as a point of contact for student-life questions.

Tour Guide Recruitment Team, *Duke Undergraduate Admissions & Pratt School of Engineering* 05/2024 - Present

- Lead candidate evaluation efforts for approximately 80 prospective tour guides, coordinating interviews and providing data-driven hiring recommendations to program leadership.
- Continue to conduct guided campus tours for inquiring students and families, communicating Duke's academic programs, student life, and campus culture with enthusiasm and accuracy.

Undergraduate Student Assistant, *Duke Student Affairs | Durham, NC* 05/2025 - Present

- Coordinate logistics, scheduling, and resource allocation for university facilities supporting student programs and events, ensuring successful execution across university leadership.
- Serve as key liaison between students, staff, and university partners to resolve operational challenges and communicate project status (*see page 2*).
- Provided administrative support to the Dean of Students Office, managing front desk operations, scheduling, and student inquiries with professionalism and confidentiality.

Teaching Assistant & Facilitator, *Girls Exploring Math* 06/2025 - 07/2025

- Collaborated with a team of four peers to facilitate daily creative mathematical projects during a two-week session for a group of thirty middle school-aged students.
- Coordinated activities and supervised students, while effectively communicating with parents and guardians to ensure a safe and engaging environment.

SKILLS & AWARDS

Skills: Data Analysis, Python, Excel, LaTeX, Figma, Structured Problem-Solving, Market & User Research, Research analysis, Handshake
Awards: VISION Leadership Award, Connestee Falls Scholarship Recipient, Blue Devil Futures Scholarship Recipient
Interest: musical theater, baking, running, pickleball, tenting, reading (currently *Outlander)*, movies & film (current favorite *The Odyssey)*

RYAN MERRILL

Brevard, NC | (828)329-0563 | ryan.merrill@duke.edu | linkedin.com/in/ryanmerrill21

LEADERSHIP

Rural at Duke (RAD), *President*

- Manage an eight-person executive team with weekly coordination meetings and 150 general body with monthly general body meetings while working with National STARS network to seek additional support for campus rural students.
- Manage organization's budget totalling $10,000 annually and lead fundraising efforts; securing resources to fund trip and conference travel; distributing academic and professional resources to student members.

StrongHER, TogetHER, *LAUNCH STEM Mentorship Program*

- Mentored a high school senior through the college application process by providing individualized feedback on personal statements, conducting weekly meetings for interview and resume development, resulting in 87.5% college acceptance rate.

Duke Honor Council, *Outreach Chair*

- Partner with student organizations and Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards to promote awareness of Duke's Conduct Code, coordinating outreach initiatives and campus events that strengthen the culture of academic integrity and community accountability.

Females and Allies Excelling More in Math, Engineering, and Science (FEMMES), *Capstone Activity Leader*

- Designed and led "Electrifying Art," a hands-on science activity for a day-long program serving local Durham students; calculated and ordered supplies for 65 participants and facilitated the group activity from start to finish.

Society of Women Engineers (SWE), *Member*
Theta Tau (Pre-professional Engineering Fraternity), *Member*

PROJECTS

Newspapers.com Innovative Product Feature, *Team Leader* 08/2025 - 12/2025

- Led cross-functional team in conducting user research and market analysis for Newspapers.com, synthesizing findings to design new product feature; developed interactive software prototypes and presented proposal to the **Ancestry.com** product team demonstrating feasibility and product-market alignment.

Student Affairs Inter-University Personnel Tour Initiative, *Project Team Member* 01/2026 - 05/2026

- Collaborated with university administrators to design operational processes and implementation plans for new inter-university tour program to be launched by the end of year.
- Selected and designed tour with detailed stops explaining student resources; collected student testimonies, collaborated on website design, and continue to finalize project

Key Performance Indicator Dashboard, *Intern* 05/2026 - 08/2026

- Developed an Excel-based KPI dashboard integrating field operations hours, incidents, incident types, safety reports, and day-of-week trends to track Total Case Incident Rate (TCIR), identify high-risk patterns, trade partner performance by measured incidents, and evaluate the effectiveness of safety initiatives.